5

Gertrude was having trouble with her period. She was usually irregular and one couldn't predict when it would come. Once she was within a week of one, however, she could tell unfailingly that one was on the way.

In the beginning of December, one was on the way, and we both waited patiently, and it didn't come. She remained premenstrual for weeks and both of us grew impatient and concerned.

On December 28, we drove to New York, and the next day I saw

1 By now the Americans had evacuated North Korea. We had not suffered such a defeat by a foreign enemy since the British took Washington in 1814—and it was MacArthur who suffered it.

Brad and told him about The Currents of Space. It was to be a complicated story of interstellar intrigue and racism. He approved.

Then to Gold's, where I rewrote "Hostess" on the spot, and he took it at $.03 a word. After that, I sat back and unloaded some of my troubles, not the least of which was my concern over Gertrude's condition. "Her period won't come," I said. "She's been on the verge all month and nothing happens."

And Evelyn Gold, who had a son, said, "For goodness' sake, Isaac, she's pregnant."

I laughed and said, "Don't be silly."

I stopped off to see Campbell the next day, and he agreed to match Galaxy's $.03 a word. He also told me that I "was one of the greatest science-fiction writers in the world." That meant much to me coming from Campbell. He didn't flatter.

And if so, he had made me that. He had brought me a long way in 13V2 years.

And so 1950 came to an end. It was the first year since 1944 * n which we did not move once in the entire year.

In it, I had published two books. Because the question often arises these days as to the number of books I have published and because I am frequently asked to list them all (which I cannot do very easily), I will list them in this book